How Nature Shapes the Australian Character

Target Audience: B1+ / B2
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach
Lesson Objectives:

- Educational (Content): Understand how Australia's dangerous wildlife and unique landscape shape the Australian lifestyle, humor, and national identity.
- Linguistic (Language): Practice vocabulary related to nature and danger (e.g., *deadly, venomous, outback, to respect, survival*), and develop viewing skills for gist and detail.
- Socio-cultural: Develop cultural understanding by analyzing the Australian attitude to danger (fear vs. respect) and comparing it with the students' home culture (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and spark curiosity.	5 min	Teacher shows a picture of a kangaroo and a snake. Ask: *"Which one is more dangerous? What do you know about deadly animals in Australia?"*	Pictures of Australian animals.
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary needed for the video.	7 min	Students match words: *deadly, venomous, outback, to respect, survival*. Look at the title *"How Nature Shapes the Australian Character"*. What do you think this means?	Vocabulary Match, presentation slide
Viewing (Part 1: 0:00–3:00)	Develop viewing skills for general understanding (gist).	6 min	Students watch the first half of the video (0:00–3:00). Question: *"Does Steve (the host) look scared or excited? Why?"* Students discuss in pairs.	Steve Irwin ... (00:00-05:55)
Viewing (Part 2: 3:00–5:55)	Develop viewing skills for specific	8 min	Students watch the second half (3:00–5:55). They	Steve Irwin ... , table

	details.		complete a True/False/Not Given task (table) about the animals and Steve's attitude.	
Post-Viewing	Develop critical thinking through visual data (CLIL).	7 min	Teacher shows an infographic: *"Top 5 Deadliest Animals in Australia"*. Students discuss: *"Why do Australians joke about these dangers? Does it make them proud?"*	Infographic on screen.
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop speaking skills through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	12 min	Role-Play "Tour Guide". Group work. Students are tour guides. They must create a 4-rule "Survival Guide" for tourists (e.g., "Always swim between the flags"). Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"How does the nature in your country shape the lifestyle of its people? Are people in your country as connected to the outdoors as Australians?"*	Survival Guide template, board
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	*"Why do you think Australians are proud of their dangerous nature?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"What is the most beautiful or dangerous nature in your country? Why?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-5) with their definitions (A-E).

Word	**Letter**	**Definition**
1. Deadly	[ ]	A. Very dangerous and able to kill you.

2. Venomous	[ ]	B. A remote, dry area of land in Australia.
3. Outback	[ ]	C. To show admiration and care for something (e.g., nature).
4. To respect	[ ]	D. The state of continuing to live despite difficulties.
5. Survival	[ ]	E. (Of an animal) able to produce poison that can kill or hurt.

Vocabulary Match

1. A
2. E
3. B
4. C
5. D

Watch the second half of the video and decide if the statements are True (T), False (F), or Not Given (NG).

1. Steve says that Australia has more venomous snakes than non-venomous ones. _____
2. Steve is afraid of the snake and wants to run away. _____
3. The video shows that Australians learn to live with dangerous animals from a young age. _____
4. Steve catches the snake with his bare hands. _____
5. The Australian government pays people to catch snakes. _____

Answers:

1. True (Steve often mentions this fact).
2. False (Steve is excited, not scared. He respects the animal).
3. True (He often talks to locals who teach kids how to be safe).
4. False (He usually uses a snake hook or a tube, not bare hands).
5. Not Given (This is not mentioned in the video).

The Australian Survival Guide

Task: You are a tour guide for foreign tourists visiting Australia. Create a "Survival Guide" with 4 important rules on how to stay safe and enjoy the nature.

Our 4 Rules:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Why do you think Australians joke about these dangers?

_____
_____
_____

📝 TASK 4: Dialogue of Cultures (Discussion)

Discuss the questions in pairs or small groups:

1. How does the nature in your country shape the lifestyle of its people?
2. Are people in your country as connected to the outdoors as Australians?
3. Is there a specific "national character" in your country? What is it like?